

DESIGNER-ENGINEER · ATLANTA

I think in systems.

I learn a business until I can see the whole of it — how it runs, how it earns, where the real problem sits. Then I collaborate to solve it, in design and in code. What follows is one of those systems, built end to end.

INTERACTIVE EXAMPLES [BARNESY.ME](https://barnesy.me) ↗



Taken by my son Maxwell from 300ft away
through a telescope.

PAST COLLABORATORS



OPENGOV · CAPITAL DESIGN SYSTEM

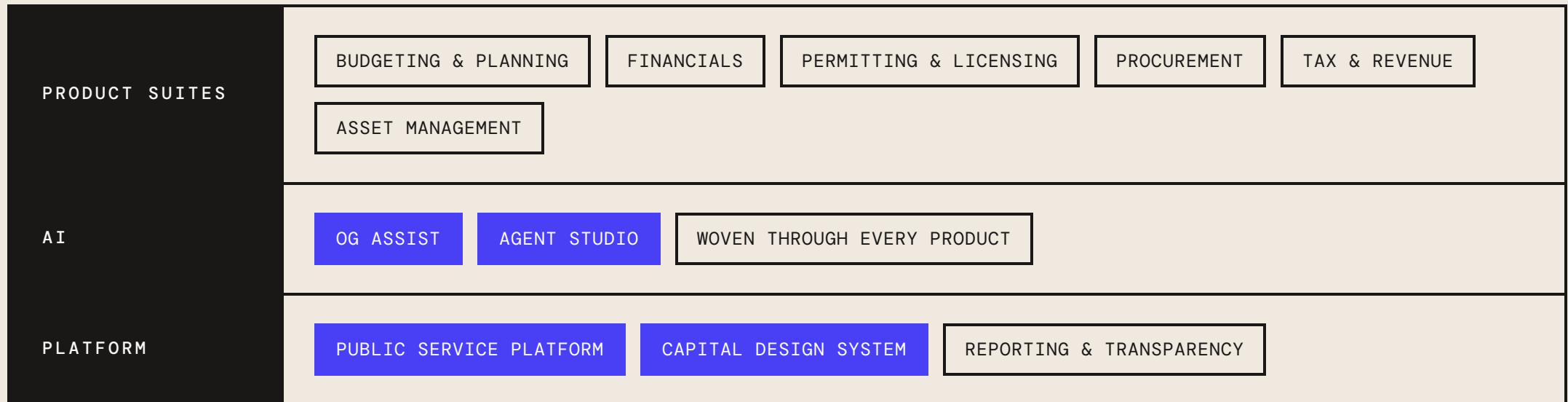
Platform to Product

Rebuilding a design system and pattern library on MUI + React, then using it to build AI products, platform, even the marketing site rebuild.

Chris Barnes

Staff Product Experience Engineer · OpenGov · 2024-2026

Thousands of local and state governments trust OpenGov with their finance, assets, and legal workflows.



■ **My ownership** — Lead designer for Platform & AI, partnering with designer and developer teams across every suite.

THE BET

A reference, rebuilt as a platform.

Tokens, patterns, validation, and agent tooling
— one team, every product.

IMPACT

A reference became infrastructure the whole org builds on.

200+

Prototypes in the first two months

20+

Designers & engineering teams trained

100%

Pattern coverage — Patterns v37

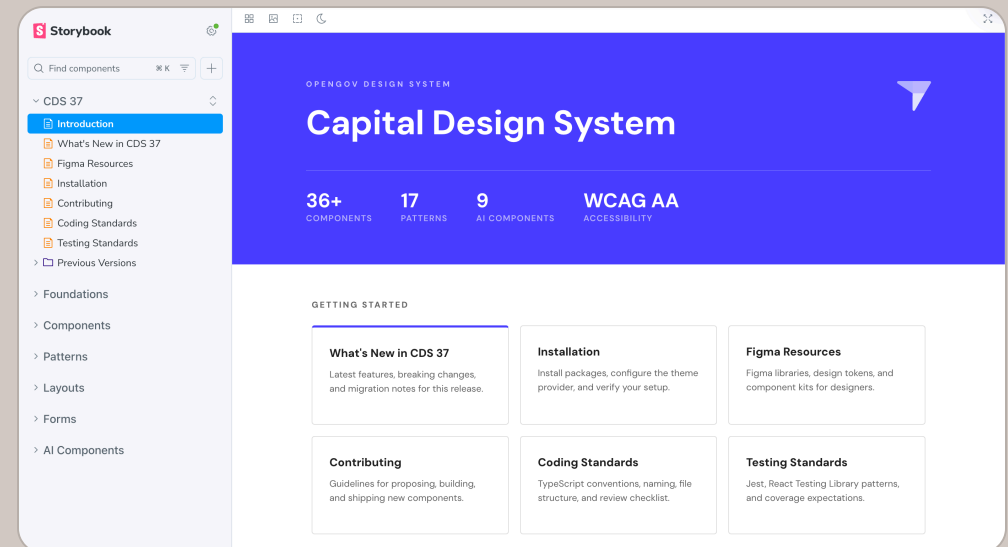
Org-wide

Claude Code adoption, pioneered

01 FOUNDATION

One source of truth

A fragmented system, unified on **MUI + React**. Patterns v37, 100% coverage.



Storybook — one source of truth
for the system

OpenGov

Budget Management

Home

Budgets

Procurement

Reporting

Administration

Home / Budgets / Operating Budget FY26

Operating Budget FY26

Manage and review fiscal year budget allocations across all departments.

Export

Add Entry

Search

Search departments...

Filter

Department	Allocated	Spent	Remaining	Utilization	Status	Action
General Administration	\$1,200,000	\$840,000	\$360,000	70%	On Track	
Public Works	\$3,500,000	\$2,100,000	\$1,400,000	60%	On Track	
Parks & Recreation	\$900,000	\$450,000	\$450,000	50%	Under Budget	
Public Safety	\$5,200,000	\$4,900,000	\$300,000	94%	At Risk	
Human Resources	\$750,000	\$400,000	\$350,000	53%	On Track	
Community Development	\$1,800,000	\$600,000	\$1,200,000	33%	Under Budget	
Information Technology	\$2,100,000	\$1,750,000	\$350,000	83%	At Risk	
Finance & Budget Office	\$980,000	\$510,000	\$470,000	52%	On Track	

BaseLayout in production – Operating Budget FY26

02 LIBRARY

Patterns, layouts, 20+ teams

Everything moved from Figma into **Storybook**. BaseLayout ships every page.

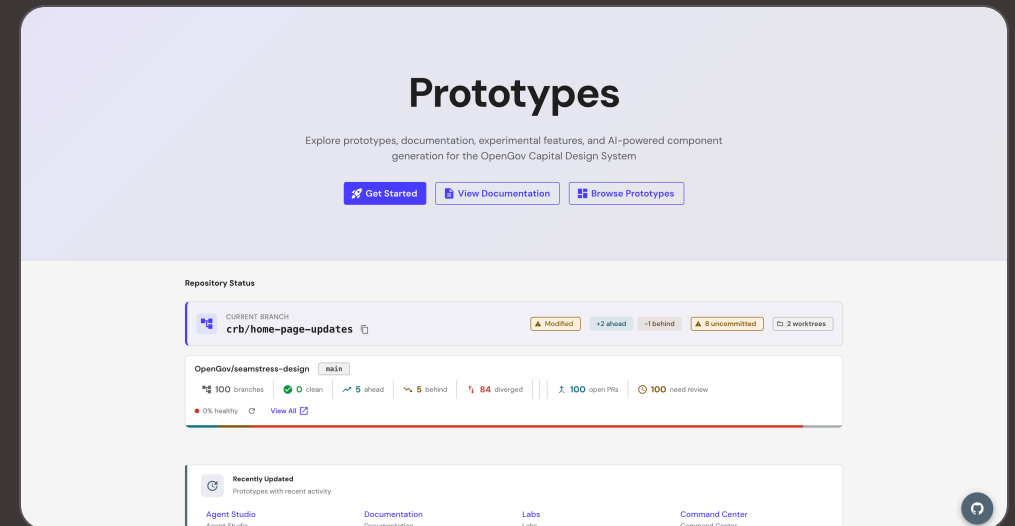
03 ADOPTION

Claude Code, company-wide.

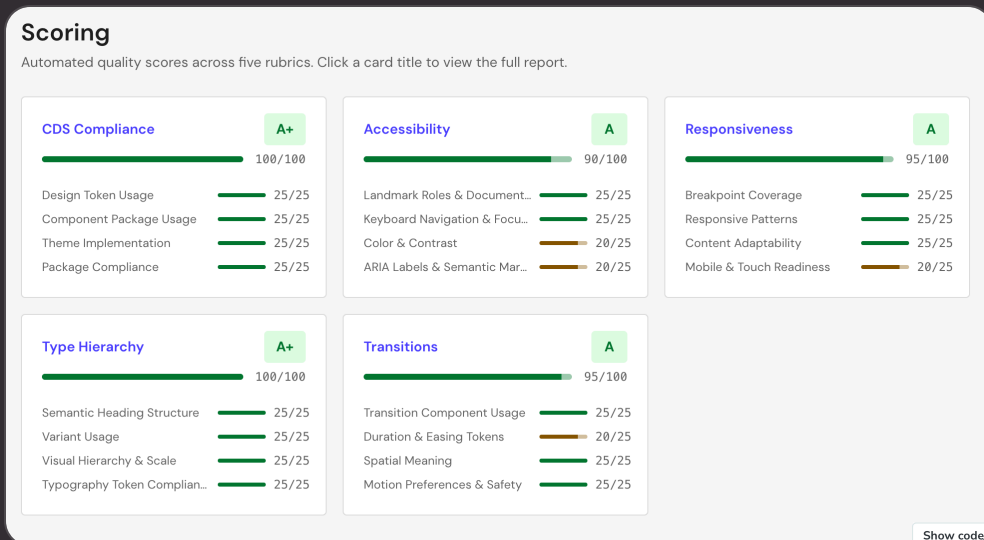
The design system became a **substrate**
agents compose against.

Prototypes, no engineer

A prototyping agent on the production system. **200+ prototypes** in two months — mostly by designers and PMs.



Real output, not mockups — built on the
production system



Five rubrics · twenty criteria · auto-
fix or human flag

05 FRONT-END AGENT

Enforcement on every PR

Production code generation, plus scoring on
five rubrics.

Compliance

All

Responsive

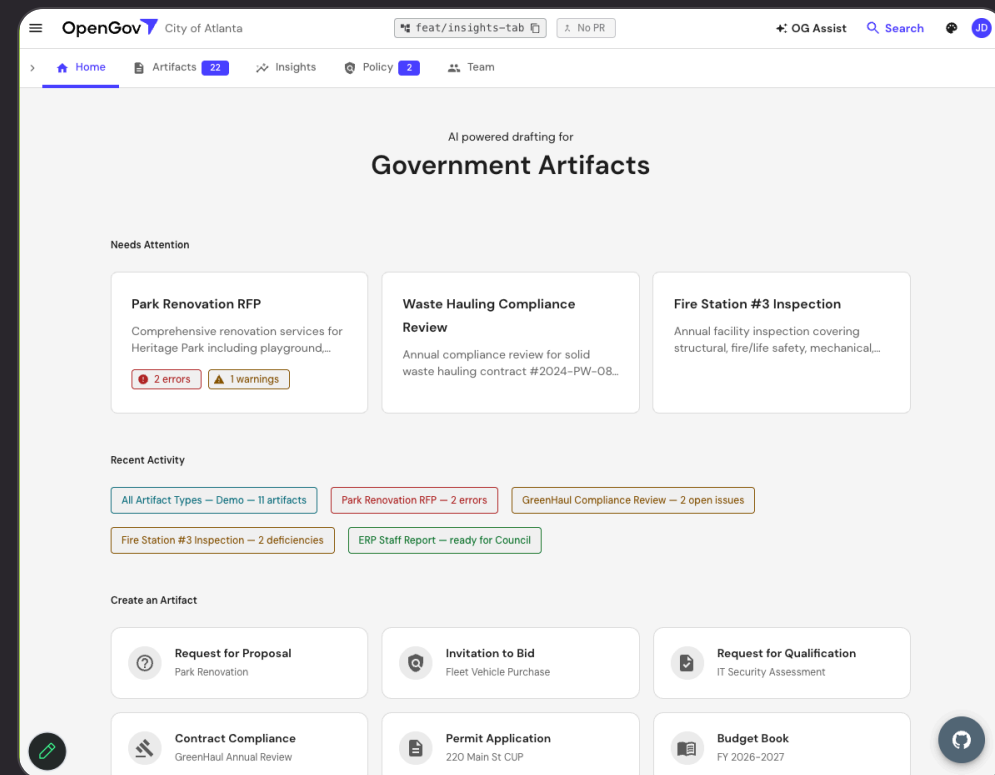
Type

Motion

IN PRODUCTION

Government Artifacts & OG Assist

Redesigned around the **document**. AI as the primary interaction, not a sidebar.



The Government Artifacts workspace,
drafted by OG Assist

WHAT'S NEXT

Bypassing Figma.

A wireframing tool inside the repo. Design and production, **one source of truth.**

IF YOU MADE IT THIS FAR...

I'm a curious artist who loves science.

I built a bathroom — plumbing and wiring included. I 3D print, paint, and experiment. I've put interactive art in public space. Same instinct as the work: understand a system well enough to build it, then make something people can actually use.

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SCAN FOR LIVE WORK